

On
Cognition
and
Inquiry.

Toward an Introduction to Academic Study.

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Preface.

There are many writings on the study of the sciences [Videnskaber] in general, and on academic study and the student's vocation [Kald] in particular. The present one is a new attempt of this kind, following a plan of its own. If giving oneself a full account of what one does and accomplishes can do nothing but advance a person in his striving and activity—so that he may come to act with complete clarity and composure—then this must be especially important for the one whose whole endeavor is precisely to examine, everywhere, the innermost nature and essence [Væsen] of things. And though there may admittedly be, in other spheres of activity, people who, instead of being advanced, would be held back and arrested—indeed led astray in their striving—were they to strain to penetrate into their own selves and search out all that underlies their active power and the natural gift they have to thank for it, this cannot hold of the student as such; for he, called to penetrate to the ultimate grounds of all cognition [Erkjendelse] and of all things, and above all to ponder the nature of spirit [Aand] and of the spiritual life, cannot exclude from that inquiry the form of life that emerges in his own inner being.

This is why, in our own time, reflections on academic study have been made the subject of separate lectures at the universities.

But if one considers more closely what belongs to such a treatment and what does not, difficulties arise—difficulties that the author of the present attempt, too, could not but feel. To clarify the nature and essence of scientific study, one must enter into considerations that other scientific disciplines nonetheless claim as their own, and the question then becomes how a boundary is to be drawn between the two. Let me be permitted a few words on this matter here, so as to clarify the relation in which this presentation is meant to stand to the other scientific developments it meets at several points.

To show what a person who strives after genuine cognition and science [Videnskab] ought to keep in view, the first and most important thing is to consider what cognition and science are. But underlying all cognizing lies thinking [Tænkning]. The ordinary

developments of logic, however, cannot belong here. Just as little does it belong here—though the life that is to live and take shape in the scientific inquirer [Gransker] is indeed the object of our consideration—to set out the various life-activities that are to be distinguished in our spiritual life, together with their relations and connections, or to enter into psychological investigations. Nor should an introduction to academic study be confused with that general introduction to philosophy which has, with good reason, lately been established as a discipline of its own. Yet this latter cannot but come into manifold contact with all these investigations. And so the question arises what an introduction to academic study really is to be and to accomplish; indeed, doubt [Tivl] may well arise whether it can even claim and fill a place alongside those other scientific presentations.

We bring this matter to clarity most easily by asking how we came—how others before us have come—to make academic study a distinct object of distinct investigation. It was because it had to matter to the student, who as such has his own particular vocation, to reflect on this vocation of his, on his striving and activity. Among the forms in which the general spiritual life that psychology considers can come forward in a particular individual existence, hypostatizing itself in a distinctive way, the life that is to live and dwell in the student is one; in other individuals, in other spheres of activity, it takes shape in other ways. What now serves to illuminate this form of life from every side, and to remind us what it really is that we as students strive for and ought to strive for—and what we, in the midst of a life in which so much can distract and confuse, or draw us toward one-sidedness [Eensidighed], hold us back and detain us, ought constantly to keep in view—this is what belongs here. And thus there appears a distinctive center around which the manifold [Mangfoldighed] that presents itself to reflection must gather into unity [Eenhed].

A presentation of this kind may be regarded as a sort of monograph. Of such self-standing scientific treatments of the whole nature and character of certain particular objects—or of objects belonging to larger scientific systems—one can conceive two kinds. The usual natural-historical ones, and those resembling them, treat their object exactly as it is otherwise treated in its place within the doctrinal edifice to which it belongs, and so are to be regarded merely as excerpted sections or pieces of the larger scientific whole—perhaps only elaborated more fully than usual. Of a different character, by contrast, is a monograph such as the present one. Items of knowledge that otherwise belong in the most diverse places in other sciences are here to gather about a single point, in order—together with, and in one with, the reflections on what is peculiar

to the object—to illuminate it fully and from every side. Such a monograph, more difficult and intricate than one of the first kind, also has a better claim to stand forth as a self-subsisting scientific inquiry, or as a smaller whole within the great whole of the sciences; for here there is a distinctive center for a scientific organization of its own, whereby a body of interconnected cognitions grows together into unity in a peculiar way. And this organization—the inner ground-form of the presentation, the inner mode of connection and sequence of its parts, the course of its development—is determined by the object's own distinctive fundamental nature, not by a norm and manner of presentation borrowed from another science and fixed by that science's course and method [Methode]. A monograph of this kind stands to the sciences to whose fundamental considerations it attaches itself—and to which much of what it presents and works out is to be traced back, though always in a distinctive way determined by the object, and in a light of its own—as a talent stands to the general activities of the mind. Take away from a talent all that belongs to understanding [Forstand] and judgment, sense and imagination, reason [Fornuft] and feeling, and nothing will remain that could be called a talent; and yet a talent is something other than those more general activities of the mind. What, then, is a talent? It is the distinctive combination of them all in certain definite directions—the distinctive organization of the mind with respect to their united cooperation, aimed at a certain kind of productivity. Just as a thorough psychological portrait of a given talent does not consist in a portrayal of those more general mental activities in general, but must presuppose them as known—while it is precisely they that it must everywhere attend to and keep in view—so a monograph like the present one may have to look toward many particular points which, taken in and for themselves, belong to definite places in definite sciences, and may have to present much that, piece by piece, other sciences could claim and draw to themselves, and can nonetheless be, and assert itself as, a distinctive scientific whole in its own right.

It was, moreover, my intention from the outset—the reader will perhaps notice this easily in several places—to lay the content of the present work before the public in a form other than the present one: in the same form in which I have several times imparted it to my listeners, the form of lectures. The lecture is, among us, without doubt the mode of presentation that could most easily take the place the dialogue holds in Plato; like the dialogue in his day, it is taken directly from life, and the development of general concepts can hardly, in any way natural to us, be better combined in a connected presentation with speech's immediate address to individuals—and take on the liveliness that must follow from such direct attention to the thinking beings who are to be called upon to

meet what is presented with their own independent thinking [Selvtænkning]—than in the form of the lecture. But the fear that I might not come even remotely close, that my attempt might fall all too far short of the ideal of such a presentation which hovered before me, brought me to abandon the execution I had already begun.

I had also intended from the outset, in the Remarks to §§ 13–17, to treat the individual principal fields of study, both with respect to the philosophical and in the other principal respects. But what I might have said about this I later decided to set aside and reserve for the oral lectures I hope still to give on academic study, for those students who are still at the beginning of their course. I dared not credit myself with such an acquaintance with so many sciences that I should be able, even in general terms, to offer reflections on their study fit to be laid before the public in print, in a word fixed for good—or at least for a long time.

I must further note that if, in the present work, I have departed from the practice I observed in the two scholarly works I have previously produced—namely, of emphasizing no word—this has happened because I believed I ought to yield to the urging of one of those among my friends to whose company I owe much, especially with respect to my philosophizing endeavor. But since I am not accustomed to underline as I write—because it almost never occurs to me that it might be necessary—and since this time I had nearly finished the whole book before the decision to do so was prompted in me, so that I carried out the underlining only at the work’s final revision, whereas the moment of writing something down is the right moment to decide which word should be emphasized—I dare not hope that I have carried out the decision with the best success, and I therefore ask the reader, who will in any case find enough else to overlook, to extend his forbearance to this too.

This is what I had to send ahead of the work I herewith deliver into the hands of the public.

Copenhagen, 13 November 1821.

Sibbern.

Synopsis.

All cognizing [Erkjenden] is essentially a finding, a receiving, and a beholding. Truth, presenting itself out there of its own accord, refers itself to an apprehending individuality and carries with it, for the latter, a necessity that produces conviction [Overbeviisning], to which a personal affection is joined. (§ 1.)

Yet we cognize only insofar as we ourselves bring forth. *Scimus, quia facimus*. A living personality cannot receive except in and through its own forth-working. (§ 2.)

Receiving and producing here become one. Precisely by ourselves shaping truth's expression or presentation within us do we receive it and are made alive by it. (§ 3.)

In pure beholding, however, productivity is lost and does not come into view. But in the striving to cognize perfectly, reflection makes it become free and show itself as such. If we ask why we come to truth only slowly, through reflection—why its fullness is not given at once—the answer is: because a realm of freedom is to come forth, so that a realm of love may become actual. (§ 4.)

The thinking called forth by reflection now leads to a cognizing by force of grounds [Grunde]. The highest cognizing would indeed be a pure beholding of perfect truth, raised above all inquiry [Gransken] and grounding; but such an immediate beholding of the highest is not granted to the human being. Rather, all his assurance rests, in the end, on an immediate faith [Tro]. (§ 5.)

The endeavor to cognize by force of grounds is an endeavor to cognize truth in its truth. This is what calls forth genuine scientific study, which first truly begins with academic study. (§ 6.)

Cognition now becomes an intelligent cognizing (as opposed to the empirical); a cognition of truth in its truth is necessarily a cognizing by force of the constitutive First, hence a cognizing *a priori*, which leads to a construction *a priori*. (§ 7.)

Such a cognizing then aims not merely at grounds for our assuming something, but at things' own grounds of existence [Tilværelsesgrunde]. All philosophizing strives to

find these. (In mathematics, by contrast, we have a great example of a cognizing—even a wholly intelligent one—that does not aim at this.) (§ 8.)

The real grounds of things we find, most immediately, in the rational orderliness [Forstandighed] that, within a coherent order of things, requires or entails them—indeed, in the concepts [Begreber] of things. (§ 9.)

But as the ultimate ground there appears an all-real active First which, in bringing a determinate order of things into actuality, sets the individual things into existence in accordance with a rational lawfulness [Forstandsmæssighed]—indeed, in accordance with concept. (§ 10.)

This all-real presents itself to us in the Idea [Idee]. Cognition is in itself the Idea's own self-presentation in consciousness, even if it does not always show itself—or is not seen and possessed by us—as such. That truth is not a mere correspondence between an assumption and its object, but is that which livingly produces this correspondence, is clear from this. (§ 11.)

The Idea presents itself to cognition and comes to outward life and subsistence in science. (§ 12.)

The first thing in all genuine science is the Idea itself, as science's center and all-determining soul. In the cognition of it, and in the tracing-back of all cognitions to it, the speculative and philosophical element in science shows itself. Yet philosophy can also show itself already in the immediately judicious—in a certain scientific way of thinking and judging. (§ 13.)

In speculation's transition to the manifold—which is thereby to be beheld in its proper light—and in the determination of that manifold, dialectic enters, partly as a philosophical art of annihilation, partly as a scientific art of construction essentially and immediately bound up with it. (§ 14.)

Genuine cognition is, further, necessarily and essentially systematic. Yet the immediately free judicious element, just as it must prepare the way for the system, must also not be displaced by it. (§ 15.)

Furthermore, in all science the exact study of the particular [Detail] is of importance. (§ 16.)

Finally, in all science method [Methode] is still to be noted. It is best developed out of the science itself and its historical course of development—just as the study of a science's history is of essential importance for the study of the science itself. (§ 17.)

Not only in science, but also, through science, in a personal individuality does the Idea take shape, and thereby come to a complete outward existence or subsistence in

real actuality. (§ 18.)

To attain this subsistence and life in the individual, the Idea then calls forth its own opposite, setting the individual's sense of independence in motion and summoning a recognition and avowal [Er- og Vedkjendelse] that is to follow on the individual's part. (§ 19.)

Independent thinking [Selvtænkning] is called forth by a questioning. The possibility of assuming, but also of not assuming, then appears. Denial and affirmation stand opposed to one another. But the assurance that arises out of doubt [Tvivl] beaten down—the Yes that comes forth from the denial of a negation—is of an entirely different nature than what has not passed through this trial. (§ 20.)

The Idea's coming to the individual then appears as a kind of testing, and everything depends on whether that now follows in the individual which is to follow. There is indeed something here that lies within the individual's power; but that on which everything depends does not lie within his power, and must, when it is given, be received as pure grace. The conflict that is here to be brought to unity is seen above all in theological study. Yet in several respects there is a trial to be undergone here, since, on the one hand, egoism easily comes to draw nourishment from the consciousness of the independent thinking to which the summons has been made, and, on the other, the very endeavor after insight can easily lead into uncertainty, confusion, and error. (§ 21.)

Finally, the Idea will live and take shape not only in individuals, but in a whole of humanity, in which each is to find himself as a member and to intervene practically in the exercise of a definite vocation [Kald]. In the choice of that vocation, science and Idea must themselves guide us. We must, further, take science with us into life, and the exercise of one's vocation must at the same time be a constantly continued study. (§ 22.)

But the highest, the one thing needful—however lofty and significant genuine cognizing may be—is nonetheless not yet cognition itself. (Conclusion.)

§. 1.

All cognizing [Erkjenden] is essentially a finding, a receiving, and a beholding. (*Scimus, quia accepimus.*)

For all cognizing aims at the true, and in and through it we are to come to truth [Sandhed]—to come to have and possess it. But truth is not something dependent on us; it is and remains, without any regard to us, what it is in itself. Ours, then, can only be to seek quite directly to become conscious of it as it is in itself and presents itself to us; but such a coming-to-consciousness is a receiving, and—when it is determinate and clear and at the same time immediate, or certain and self-evident by itself alone—a beholding. But this immediate, self-certain element is present at every point in all cognizing, even when we reach it in a mediated way; for cognition then still always rests on the insight that, from such prior cognitions, the present one follows—and this following, or consequence, must be self-evident directly, or must be beheld. With this, what thus follows likewise shows itself as that which, on the presupposition of the truth of the prior cognitions, is self-evident, though only on that same presupposition is it also cognized. So that even relative and mediated cognition, at the point where it first enters by virtue of its mediateness, proceeds from a direct insight, and so far is itself an insight and a beholding. It is a beholding that gradually develops. In every case it is a receiving.

As such, it is always and essentially bound up with a necessity to represent [forestille] just as one does represent, and not otherwise. The immediate feeling of this necessity is conviction [Overbeviisning], which can arise only in that we are immediately seized by it and feel it. The object of cognition presses itself upon us, and precisely as it is now cognized to be.

The true that is cognized thereby shows itself as that which exerts a determining and effective influence in us—an influence in which it expresses and presents itself, and thereby lives again, in us.

Remark and Supplement.

1. That all cognizing is a receiving and a beholding is soon taught, too, by a glance at the various domains of cognition. Not only what strikes the eye at once: that the *beginning* of all cognition—in the higher spheres just as much as in the lowest sensory one—is a direct becoming-aware and apprehending, a noticing and sensing. In its advance toward the highest completion, too, it remains an immediate taking and beholding. In the domain of lower sensation this is at once, at first glance, entirely obvious; for although here a certain combining and synthesizing activity must indeed be added to the apprehending

one—so that sensation comes about only by means of a reproducing construction—this construction too aims only at presenting the thing exactly as it is found and as it presents itself to us. We feel ourselves affected, and just as the affection brings it about, so sensation turns out: precisely as we are determined to it by this affection, so must we represent. And though a difference not seldom arises here between what seems to be and what is found to be in itself, still this latter too is found, and must precisely be cognized, only as it is found through a scrutiny—if not by sense, then by deliberating reflection.

As it here shows itself in the sphere of the senses and of the experience they occasion, so it stands with every higher cognizing of the understanding [Forstand] or of reason [Fornuft]—indeed, it is especially striking in the highest cognizing. Whatever is cognized without appeal to experience, by an insight springing from pure thinking—whether by force of mathematical demonstration or of a priori reflection or of philosophical speculation—is always cognized as something that is seen to have to be so, and a necessity of understanding or of reason, determining our whole representing, thereby enters: as this necessity declares it to be, so it must be cognized to be. But when, in this way, all reflection—all comparing, connecting, and inferring—aims at investigating or fathoming what must necessarily be assumed, as it will itself turn out to be, so that it is cognized as true only in being cognized as the one thing that can be assumed, then reflection aims at letting the thing *give* itself, by letting it be forced upon one through a necessity of thinking. It is cognized only in being discerned—that is, seen and beheld (with the higher eye of the spirit [Aand])—as it is in itself. The triangle I construct; but that its angles together equal two right angles I discern as necessary in accordance with the triangle's own nature, once given to me. Indeed, in the very act of constructing it, I do so in a certain determinate way and under certain conditions, and this manner of construction and these conditions I must take as they force themselves upon me. All sorts of human circumstances and relations I can think out for myself (though even here I must proceed according to certain given conditions and determinations); but what, in a given relation, is right or wrong, good or bad, the fundamental Idea [Grundidee] of the good and the right must teach me, so that by it I must let myself be guided in my judgment, and in every case let stand as right and good what, in accordance with that Idea, I see to be right and good. Mine it can only be to inquire into the essence [Væsen] of the right and the good, and then to cognize it as it presents itself to my spiritual eye. So that, even if the cognizing which goes beyond mere experience is called forth by questions—which, as inner spurs to seek more than the experienced, show that we do not rest content with what is given in experience alone—still the whole thinking thereby set in motion leads

only to a new receiving and apprehending of a higher order, under which we must again seek directly to observe and behold what presents itself to us.

But now, in the receiving and beholding in which all cognizing consists, we also become aware of a *principal distinction*. What we apprehend and come to know through the senses—indeed also what the ideal or intellectual becoming-aware and beholding, which enters already in this sphere by way of thinking, can teach us, when the inner ground-forms of the things revealed to the senses, their relations and their activities, are cognized exactly as they are directly found—all this is merely received, as something given to us from without in the reality that presents itself in time and space. This cognizing is the merely *empirical* kind; the necessity by which it enters, and by which it acquires the character of a cognizing, is only a necessity of the sort that proceeds from a certain *affection* bound to time and space—a wholly sensory affection of a lower nature. What is cognized in this way is still cognized only as *contingent*. It is given to us as the actual, and for us there is a necessity to take it so; but that it should itself necessarily be as it is, is not yet seen in this merely empirical cognizing.

Of a wholly different kind, by contrast, is mathematical and philosophical cognizing; here there is an intellectual beholding that has nothing of that stamp of contingency. What is here cognized is not merely taken as given, as though that were enough, but is apprehended and represented as something that is so because it must be so, in accordance with an inner *necessity of understanding and reason* of a wholly different origin than that by which certain sensory affections force themselves upon us. It is indeed given to us, but given from within—or at least given as something that accords with an inner demand, and not at all given to us by way of sensory affections. It is cognized as something that cannot be otherwise; it is cognized as *essential*, and therefore valid for all times and everywhere—which is why only in this sphere can one speak of eternal truths. We will call this cognizing the *intelligent* kind, both because this word seems more apt than the word “intellectual,” and because the latter can also cover the just-mentioned merely empirical—yet still ideal—cognizing, in which the inner ground-forms and relations of things are apprehended entirely as they are directly found in experience.

2. Necessity enters when truth shows itself in relation to (refers itself to) *the individuality* that takes it up; and in the feeling of conviction, the life and working of the true in the individual is met by something purely individual, in which a person shows himself and comes forward as such, in that he attaches himself wholly to, and gives himself over to, that working. In pure receiving and beholding, the true was as yet seen only as presenting itself, so that only its own (universal) appearance showed

itself therein—no personal life. The reception was merely like a reflection or mirroring, like that by which water gives back light and color—not a personal taking-up, like that by which the gemstone has, in its color, taken a power and effect of light into itself, into unity with its own nature and existence. But in conviction it becomes an inward appropriation, whereby the true that presents itself in and for an individuality now also comes to dwell powerfully in this individuality, as in a being in which it has taken its seat, and which itself now is and becomes something through the reception. In this binding-together of the true and the individual into unity, the necessity that is indeed present is so lost that it is not particularly felt or brought into view. Here there is an *undivided* free life in the true, raised above the feeling of necessity. Only when the individual, tearing itself loose from the universal, moves in a particular personal striving does the opposition—and with it that same necessity—come to light.

3. In conviction, a personal *affection* and emotion, *πάθος*, is added to the reception—with a personal attachment and devotion to the power of truth—so that the individual not only lets truth gain room and power within him, but does so with delight, feeling that in this he possesses something and that his personal life is thereby expanded and heightened. The devotion now shows itself as *love*. This brings it about that, together with the power of the true, personality and freedom too come fully forward; for in love an independent being goes willingly and gladly to meet the true. Whereby the endeavor to cognize shows itself as a cultus or *worship* of truth. The inquirer's [Gransker] relation to truth and to his science [Videnskab] now becomes a *religious* relation—in the not ordinary, but literal and far-reaching sense in which the word denotes a relation, bound by sacred ties, to something holy, in whose power we feel ourselves, with willing devotion, to be. (Indeed, in the word's more ordinary and proper sense too the relation can show itself as religious; for just as a human being can and should do all that he does with God in view and out of love for God—so that this highest motive can and should be the everywhere-operative one—so too not only can that same motive, as such, embrace the scientific endeavor as well, but everything can and should in the end be cognized and beheld in its relation to the highest divine in such a way that the Idea of God becomes, scientifically, the all-illuminating, just as, practically, the all-animating. So that in the end every relation to truth shows itself directly as a relation to God. But in this we look toward an ideal that the scientific culture [Videnskabelighed] of humanity is still far from having approached.) With reverence for the voice of truth, and a heartfelt desire to bring it—and it alone—to speak and live in his inquiry, the votary of science must give himself over to being its organ, its servant and herald, who wills only what it wills.

His personality must be as a holy temple for it. But at the same time the speaking and living of the true within him must be felt and held fast as his own innermost and best life, and the relation must show itself as a true relation of love. What has sometimes been said—that a person is consecrated to his science and his art—we may recall here. To be kindled by truth, and then to take it up and faithfully preserve and tend it within us, until it grows and develops of itself and takes shape in us, so that it may truly come to fulfillment in us—this is ours. Let love of truth [Sandhedskjerlighed] be, like all genuine love, careful and conscientious.

Truth thereby shows itself as that which, *by its own might and power*, seeks to take shape in the individual, while the individual gives himself over entirely to letting it work in him whatever it will. And just as this holds of everything that, in any science or body of knowledge, shows itself as the true whose cognition study aims at, so everything set forth here holds of every scientific endeavor—even of one that still stands so far from the higher Ideas that it only rarely feels itself inspired by them. In *every* study, faithful devotion to the cognition that forms itself in us will bring the fullness that love gives. If, in the lower domains of inquiry, what we cognize seems not to bring us nearer to the eternal, still the fact that it produces complete cognition and living conviction in us will make us feel as though filled by a divinity. (Just as, even in the lowest spheres, cognition in itself really does come from the higher source, even if it does not come to consciousness as such. See § 11, Remark 2, below.) So that every study in which faithful and clear inquiry prevails has its *Muse*. In it the individual stands over against something he would make his own, needing it as something without which he himself cannot come to full life. But what he would thus make his own is not something he can treat as an object for the satisfaction of a sensory need—to consume, or to take as a mere vehicle or means. It always remains standing over against the individual as something that subsists in and for itself in its significance and worth, whether or not it comes to the individual—indeed, as something that has worth for the individual precisely only insofar as it has worth and significance (that is, in this case, has truth) in and for itself. And thus, everywhere that truth is sought, in whatever sphere, the relation between the individual and the true he seeks is such a relation of attachment as can—and, under a genuine striving, also will—become a relation of love.

We now also see here what it is to *inquire*, to *fathom*, to *reflect*—or, as one less felicitously puts it, to carry out reflection, investigation, consideration upon something. Namely, that it can be nothing other than, under this or that arrangement and handling of certain representations, to try to bring it about that the truth we desire to know may

come, of itself, by its own might and influence, to present itself to us—so that we now directly become aware of it or, as one says, find it out.

We must therefore also *immerse* ourselves in every study. Only thereby does it become genuine and powerful. If the true that produces cognition in us is to gain us into its power, so that it may form and shape itself in us, then we must forget everything else over it and, as it were, lose ourselves in it. Even the sensory forms of things are only then observed and apprehended fully in their distinctiveness and manifoldness when attention is thereby wholly captivated, as though we were entirely absorbed in the contemplation, or lost in it; for only then does the living *nisus formativus* that here enters—under which the true would take shape in us—work whole and undivided in its full strength. A book is best studied and works most fully when, for a time, it so captivates us and, as it were, takes our whole mind into possession, that we are wholly immersed in it. In this way—that is, with this vigorous attention and devotion—should every *classical* work be studied.

But only *classical works*, too, deserve and can be wholly studied thus. For a scientific work is classical not by the collection of items of knowledge it may contain, and which can now be drawn and learned from it piece by piece, but by its spirit as a whole, its inner genius, which speaks out of it in its totality, and by the total form that accompanies this—the way in which everything in it is presented and composed and, as it were, grown together into unity, so that everywhere in the work we meet the same vigorous and profound spirit, and all the manifold in it is as though of one piece. Such a work stands, by its spirit and by its form, valid and significant for all times, which the word “classical” especially seems to indicate; for it works not merely by a manifold of material that can be transplanted and reworked, but works as a whole by its distinctive original stamp, whereby spirit speaks to spirit. But then this spirit too must work in its totality and, as it were, enter into the reader or beholder—and it does so all the more, the more he immerses himself in the contemplation, so that he treats the work not merely as a means to the acquisition of knowledge, but as a work that has full worth by and in itself alone, and therefore also works toward the very formation [Dannelse] (*Bildung*) of the spirit as a whole.

We must read in such a way that we enter into a *harmonious relation of reciprocal action* with what we read, and are so set in motion that, through the words and sentences, we come to feel ourselves addressed by the general spiritual element in the work, which constitutes the inner source and first mover (*primus motor*) of the words and sentences—the soul that lives and speaks in them. Only such reading is a truly soulful reading.

The study of a work thus becomes an inner communion with a glorious spirit, which in several respects can have a beneficial influence on us and advance us in our whole striving. It becomes, throughout, all the more genuine nourishment for us the more it is a *disinterested* study; for the more we inquire and probe not for the sake of this or that particular aim, but solely out of pure love of truth, in order to take it up entirely into ourselves, the more it will work in us with its full power. The more our devotion is undivided, free, and wholehearted, the more easily and fully can the total immersion, or being-gripped, come about. For a time, then, we let the work carry us away, and let it do with us, and make of us, what it will. Thereupon truth's own power itself begins to speak in us and to bear witness to what is expressed in the work; whereby an immersion in our own immediate contemplation of the intrinsically true is added to the immersion in the work's utterance, and now determines what the work is to make of us.

In general, the spirit that lives and addresses us in a work can, of course, come to carry us away and captivate us, and become for us a source of new effects and formations of life within us, only in that it comes from truth itself—indeed, from that which can present itself immediately to every inquirer, enter into everyone, and in everyone bear witness to itself. Only in that we find the same thing again in ourselves, so that we sympathize with it, can what is handed down to us speak to us through the forms of transmission in which it is imparted. (This holds even of the study of the works of nature; nature too is a book that must be studied like any other book, but in which a spirit akin to us also speaks to us: the same truth that bears witness to itself within us as well. Yet this will only become fully evident in what follows. See § 7, in the Remark.) To grasp, cognize, and enjoy a work handed down to us we come, in the proper sense of the word, only in that it *reproduces itself in us*, and we, in the course of this its reproduction, are moved and enlivened by the spirit which—just as it now lives again in us—first lived in the activity by which the work came into being. But by this we are led directly to the next principal consideration, as we take into closer examination this reproduction, which shows itself as one whereby we ourselves are productive.

§. 2.

All cognizing comes to actuality and subsistence by means of a determining, a doing, a producing—and only by means of such; so that the latter is essentially bound up with the former. *We cognize only insofar as we produce. (Scimus, qvia facimus.)*

Cognition takes place when the true shows itself as such to a personality and is taken up by it. But a personality must reveal itself in a personal life. Now a life cannot be

conceived without a Something, a real [Reale], in which it expresses itself in uninterrupted activity, continually forming and determining this real, or outward, of its own; it gives itself a definite shape in giving this a definite shape. Personality, on the other hand, shows itself in finding and positing itself as the immediate center of its own existence [Tilvær], and in having this existence as its own. A personal life, then, must express itself in an activity and productivity in which the personal being finds and moves itself as the producing agent. If, then, the true is to be taken up into the personality, it too must be embraced by this personal productivity. The individual can therefore cognize only in that it itself works and produces a real—a (psychic) outward—corresponding to the cognition, in which it holds the cognition fast by determining and developing this outward.

Consciousness is the personality's first expression. In it is taken up everything that is to be taken up into the personality. Thus we too can cognize only by becoming conscious of what is to be cognized. But this, according to the fundamental nature of consciousness, we can do only by presenting it to ourselves, or representing it to ourselves [forestille] (objectifying it for ourselves). But this presenting or representing is our own act of fixing, whereby we posit (or *ponere*) the given and received before us and, as it were, make ourselves an inner image of it, in which we express it for ourselves and hold it fast. In this representing consists, here, that productivity. The representation [Forestilling] is our own product and, as an expression of our own life which we keep as ours, cannot be anything else. But only in this constant representing, and under its constant determination, development, and completion, do we come to cognize, and do we have what we cognize.

The possession of cognition therefore also shows itself as an *ability*, a *capacity*. We know only (sufficiently and fully) what we are able to bring forth in one form or another and thereby give to others. This productivity of ours, by which the received is now embraced, is also in itself a free one, which can arbitrarily present something other than the true. In cognition, however, this free element is bound and determined to a single way of representing, by the necessity that accompanies cognition and now comes forward in this respect too.

Remark and Supplement.

1. Here we see the essential connection of *language and speech* with cognition. All cognizing that does not aim at immediate or reproduced sense-intuitions, or at constructions carried out directly in time and space in the same way as these (such as, for example, the mathematical ones), takes place by means of a constant judging, which in turn takes

place through an inner speaking, by means of words (or possibly other signs), and cannot come about in any other way. But that this is so—which experience teaches directly as a fact—also shows how immediately a positing, determining, and producing activity is added to our apprehending and receiving. In word and speech we set what is cognized before us, thereby binding it and taking possession of it, making it something of our own, which we now, in our own way—in our designating and naming—hold fast (cf. Hegel's *Encyklopädie*, § 379 and the following §§).

2. Yet not only by words: in all representing generally we do the same. The preservation of representations after the immediate beholding is past, as well as everything we can do with them, testifies to this generally. The productivity essentially belonging to all cognizing also soon shows itself, to the observing eye, in every one of cognition's domains. As for simple *lower sensation*, we refer to the psychological observations that lead directly to the insight that spatial forms and relations, as well as temporal determinations and the qualities ascribed to things in respect of these, are cognized only by means of a reproducing construction of the objects that present themselves—observations which, already merely as such, lead to conclusions that justify assuming the same as regards the merely visible, audible, and other merely sensory qualities. (See the author's *Psychologie*, § 55.) How *thinking* takes place, and the cognizing springing from it comes about, by means of a constant determining, positing, and constructing, the logical investigations teach throughout and everywhere. Whether concrete objects are conceived and their nature thereby cognized by force of concepts [Begraber], or concepts themselves are regarded as the objects to be cognized, in either case construction takes place. For the former happens only when a connection is discerned; but this connection is seen only when the manifold whose connection it is is set apart from one another and then joined again into a whole, by means of a reproducing construction or a genetic procedure, under which we let the thing arise before us—that is, ourselves form it for us in an image—and now also see everything in its place, in that we see the necessity of setting it thus into the whole. Connection, and the real significance of objects within a certain coherent whole, can be cognized only by projecting and completing the intuition [Anskuelse] corresponding to it; to cognize it is to produce, or at least to be able to produce, its concrete expression. The concepts themselves, next—which are thereby abstracted, as the connections thus beheld in things and the ground-forms and real meanings thereby determined, or as the fundamental thoughts expressing themselves in things themselves—are cognized only when they are lifted out on their own, by cognizing their so-called content: that is, the sum of determinations that, according to the concepts,

must be found in the object and can be asserted of it as predicates. Whereby the judging mentioned above enters, as a determining, a fixing, and a pronouncing. Deductions of concepts—whereby the fundamental thought that determines the concept's whole validity and content is derived, or seen in its origin from a higher cognition—take place, like inferences and proofs, through trains of thought in which thoughts are linked to thoughts by determinations, whereby a whole of thought is developed. The deduction of concepts takes place only through a construction of the scientific whole, in which the concept now shows itself as an essential member; and proofs likewise come about only through combinations. An Idea [Idee], finally, is likewise cognized only in that it is either beheld as the expression of a higher Idea—in which respect, on the side of form, it shows itself as a concept—or else beheld as the essence, the determining being, and moreover as the real principle, giving essentiality and existence, in real objects and ground-forms; which objects and ground-forms are then not only, like all others, cognized solely by means of constructions, but can also be seen as the expression of the Idea only in being seen as those which through it become what they are—something that can be seen only under a reproducing, genetic presentation.

§. 3.

Reception and production, beholding and one's own determining and doing, here become entirely one, so that cognition, precisely in entering under the one form, essentially also takes on the other. (*Scientia et potentia in idem coincidunt.*)

In cognition, the production and presentation is not arbitrary but one determined with necessity, and what determines it is precisely our receiving and beholding, and the true that presents itself in and for it. As thereby the whole manner and character of the representation [Foretelling] is determined, the true expresses itself—but through our productivity, which it governs and determines, and in our product, which now nonetheless becomes the expression of that true, and, as it were, becomes the material in which the true realizes and individualizes itself in us, while at the same time our own life too realizes and substantializes itself therein. We are determined in beholding, but determined to produce something ourselves—namely, to form representations that become ours, yet such that we produce them precisely so as to correspond to our having-been-determined. And thus we are determining and determined in one. What is given to us or presents itself to us comes to clarity in us—indeed, comes to be ours at all—only in what we ourselves do. And yet here too cognition takes place only by means of a constant receiving and beholding; for that by which we are determined we have only in this its

determining influence, and the representation likewise, as necessary in accordance with that having-been-determined, takes on the same character. *We produce as we see that we must produce.*

The personality, insofar as it finds itself as a consciousness and self-determination—or we, who call ourselves “we”—find ourselves here between *two regions*. On the one side, the influence by which we are determined, and to which we turn and look as we receive and are determined; on the other side, our sphere of representations, which we ourselves work over and make into what it becomes, in that we seek therein to hold fast the received and make it our own. The former, as determining, above us, before us; as that which is to be expressed and to come to shape in us—the more inward and active, that by which we are governed. The latter, as our product, below us; as that in which we express our life—the more outward, the psychic material of our life, by its nature an object of our governing. Here there is always, on the one side, something that is obtained and possessed merely through the mastery it exercises in us, or the determining influence it has on our working and determining; on the other side, something that is merely expression, presentation, or result, which is had and kept only through a capacity or skill to reproduce it.

This latter may now remain behind as merely bare, lifeless material, like a residuum of the activity—as something now merely had and assumed because it was once assumed, a *standing result*, without its being any longer enlivened by the living activity by which it was *formed*. But it should not be mechanized or crystallize itself in this way; rather, it should be kept constantly ready, in the course of life’s advance, to enter again under the living influence of that determining First, and, under a constantly living and organic rebirth, to receive transformations and new shapes. Only then is the relation preserved as it is in itself and therefore also ought to be. As the influences from above, from within, from that which is before us, direct and command, so ought we to work in our lower and outer sphere.

Remark and Supplement.

1. In all cognizing by means of thinking (concept and Idea) this opposition and doubleness is clear. Concepts, as such, are had and held fast only either by means of the constructions whose norms they are, or by means of the judgments by which their so-called content is determined. But the norm, or determining fundamental thought, of a construction indeed enters and comes forward in it as governing and ruling, yet is not itself constructed; it is therefore had only in the living activity that proceeds from it. In judgments a concept is expressed, in that its content is determined; but since this content is a sum of

determinations ascribed not to the concept itself but to its objects—yet in accordance with the concept—the concept here too is had only as the determining fundamental thought of a doing and determining, and is not embraced by it, but hovers over it, or constitutes the inner first moving ruler within it, its inner *primus motor*. Which holds still more of every Idea. The concept can, to be sure, in turn be regarded as an object that is itself determined; but this can then happen only in accordance with another concept, which then constitutes the ruling fundamental thought in the determinations. Such ruling fundamental thoughts or concepts, which are had only in what is posited and carried out by force of them, also underlie all inferences. In lower sensation, too, a determining first enters into opposition to the representation thereby determined. In striving to see and hear rightly and precisely, and to obtain a complete representation of the object in which it can show itself in its full distinctiveness, then—precisely because the need for one’s own doing now comes forward—that which is to be beheld will also show itself as that toward which one must constantly look: that is, as that by which that doing is governed and mastered, and which is obtained only by developing, in accordance with its own determining influence, a complete image of it.

2. The apprehending and cognizing individuality here shows itself as one which, just as in its representations it forms a material in which it expresses its cognizing and life, so too is itself formed into being that in which truth expresses itself—quite as if the individuality were itself, in turn, the substrate or material of the self-presenting truth, in which the latter seeks to come to appearance and to take shape (cf. § 4, Remark 3). *Thereby we grow*, on the one side, *into that* whole in which a universal life expresses and realizes itself, in that we are embraced, filled, and made alive by it as members or organs; while on the other side a whole also grows and develops in us, in which we ourselves realize ourselves as personal beings subsisting for ourselves. We are ourselves assimilated by that more general life, in the very act of seeking to assimilate to ourselves the true that presents itself to us, by assimilating to ourselves its expression within us.

I refer here to the ingenious Franz Baader’s treatise in Schelling and Markus’s *Jahrbücher der Medicin*, third volume, first part, as well as to several of his shorter philosophical-biological writings.

§. 4.

In simple, pure, wholly immediate beholding, productivity is *bound* and *lost*, or is so absorbed therein that it does not come into view on its own, or come to consciousness, and stir according to its particular nature—just as neither is the influence, with its

determining and compelling power, felt and brought to consciousness as such. The opposition between the cognized true and the individuality in and for which it comes forward does not here show itself as an opposition. This cognizing is also, as regards the manner of cognizing, the most perfect; for the fact that the production comes entirely of itself proves that truth works with complete power, and that it is also taken up fully.

But in a striving to cognize quite fully what presents itself immediately in this beholding, and at the same time to cognize still other and more—because what is thus cognized points to other and more—the *object of cognition and the cognizing personality*, which in pure beholding were undivided, step, by means of a reflection, *apart from one another* and against one another. Productivity becomes unbound and shows itself as free, while the determining influence, on the other side, shows itself as such, with its necessity. The individual finds itself as one that must itself work, by way of deliberation and thinking, to reach the desired cognition; and just for that reason productivity must show itself as a free one, capable of presenting something other than what is found. But now, therefore, the attachment too will be embraced by self-determination and will occur in accordance with a willing. Truth now shows itself as an object that we can come to possess only gradually, by effort, through a free activity that must accord with truth's declarations—to which we must now attend closely, as they gradually sound to us in the course of our inquiry. Whereby productivity, while showing itself as free, is bound and mastered anew, so that it presents only in the one true way—yet in such a way that it now occurs with self-determination, and as one that could act otherwise, and therefore also by way of deliberation, and such that a free choice is possible. But pure, wholly immediate beholding—through a new, complete self-loss of the productivity that has come to clarity and self-consciousness—is nonetheless that toward which one strives, so that truth in its full fullness may enter into the cognizing personality.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The productivity that has become free can now also *express itself in its own* productions, independent of the given. But even therein it will always be determined—since it must take place in definite ways—by certain norms or concepts, which of themselves govern within it and are had directly in and through the power with which they determine the self-activity. And if these productions are to be more than a play with representations, then this freer productivity—although its products are now not to be mere images of what is found, but its own creations—must nonetheless, in the same way as in the endeavor to cognize, be bound and mastered anew by a higher cognition, under which the true shows itself to us in new forms and takes shape in us. So it is in mathematics and in art.

In general, life comes forth just as fully in action and self-activity as in a striving to cognize. In the former, free forth-working prevails, but also a certain cognition, which underlies it as governing and moving First. But here too the two opposites can, in the same way, be lost or merge into one, as in mere beholding, so that neither is the self-activity particularly felt as free, nor does the fundamental thought guiding it come to consciousness as such, since the action happens entirely of itself: a self-activity that, as regards its manner of working, is the most perfect—since therein the true and the being, the essentiality that is to take shape in us in our acting too, shows itself as that which works with complete, undivided, and unarrested power.

2. So far as the free productivity comes to consciousness as such, cognition's determining First too comes to consciousness as such; and vice versa. In a free working at cognizing, as in an acting undertaken with self-conscious self-determination, there can therefore, while *something* comes particularly *into view*, be *something else* deeper or more inward which, with its determining influence, is lost or merges into the cognition or the self-activity—in which respect the productivity, in another respect become free, does not show itself as free. But a reflection can then afterward, in a striving for deeper cognition, draw forth what was thus present hitherto but was lost in the whole. —Thus, for example, the principle of causality may at one time underlie, as a determining fundamental thought, a striving to fathom certain phenomena, without this principle being thought of; at another time reflection is turned upon it; and the standpoint at which the cognizing striving stands in the former case is quite other than in the latter.

3. But why does the true, full essence of things not show itself at once to the individual striving after cognition in such a way that all cognizing becomes a pure, immediate beholding? It is natural that this question should arise here. But its complete answer would require a general reflection on the ground of there being a time and a temporality at all, and of life's coming forth at all in a becoming [Vorden], under which it only gradually attains a definite subsistence—something for whose full elucidation a fathoming of the innermost meaning and essence of all human existence [Tilvær] would be needed. —Only the first basic features of such a consideration can find place here.

In the finite world the eternal and divine is to come forth, rule, and hold sway, so as therein to reveal its infinite power and fullness: this is the meaning of everything finite—that it is to be *the Other* than the eternal, in which the eternal is to come forth and reveal itself. But only in a consciousness and spiritual life does the eternal and divine reveal itself *as such*—in that the being in which it lives comes to know of it, and moreover not only to bear it within itself and be moved by it, but also itself to be able

to behold and have it as what it in its truth is. But the kingdom that is thus to come to the human being is to be a *kingdom of love*; for only in such a one does the true fullness of the eternal come to show itself, and to show itself in its pure spirituality, uniting a community of beings who are themselves spirits into a whole that can now in truth be called the kingdom of God: the kingdom in which God himself reveals himself in his divinity, in that he reveals himself in eternal love. But a kingdom of spirit and love *necessarily* presupposes—and therefore necessarily calls forth—as the other in which it is to be the ruling element, *an intelligence and freedom*. If, on the part of the beings to whom this kingdom is to come, a free and fully conscious devotion did not come to take place—namely, a devotion of one's own mind, one's own desire and impulse—then it would not be a kingdom of love that came forth. But a personal life that is to be a free one—which now, out of pure love and moreover with clear consciousness, is to give itself over to being enlivened and filled by the divinity, and to move only in God—must itself make itself into such a free life, in coming to clarity about the true meaning and essence of its own existence, and likewise of the whole of existence. But then the opposition must come forth fully, so that the reconciliation may become the true reconciliation and unity in love and freedom. But if consciousness is thus to come to self-consciousness and intelligence, telling itself what it is—if the personality is to come to freedom under a self-determination in which it takes itself as such and makes itself free—then it must come to a productivity in and under which it objectifies itself for itself. It must come to express itself in a sphere (that lower region mentioned above), which is its own, which it forms for itself, and in which it becomes conscious of itself and of its freedom in a free productivity. And thus life descends into a time and a temporality.

The personal being can, to be sure, no more make itself free (although we came to use this expression) than it can give itself truth. It finds itself free as regards possibility, but to have and enjoy freedom in deed (*actu*) it comes only through the liberating power of truth and love. But now it cannot be liberated either, except *in and through its own self-determination*—and that a self-determination which it itself wills and feels as its own. That which brings and gives the individual all reality, essentiality, and fullness can, since it is a kingdom of love that is to form itself, give it the fullness only by referring itself to *something* that must now *follow* in the individual itself, as the individual's own self-determining: namely, its own self-surrender and the acting that follows from it. The decision (that in which the whole working concludes or ends) must always be the individual's own. Therefore, too—so that we may still note this—the inner effects, in which the life that is to come to reality operates or presses forward into consciousness,

have the character of incitement and summons: namely, a summons to seek what the individual can obtain only when it desires and craves and seeks it, but which it can doubtless likewise obtain only in that it is given to it outright. But of this again further on; see §§ 19–21. In order that freedom may fully come to consciousness, and a complete self-consciousness may set in—yet so that this self-consciousness also clearly beholds what it is to strive to make itself into, so that now spirit and truth may be had in spirit and truth—for this reason the latter opens itself to the individual only gradually, under the individual's own striving, inquiry, and labor.

§. 5.

Insofar as the opposition between the object of cognition and the cognizing personality comes forward in such a way that productivity, or representation, shows itself as free—yet is now brought, by an incoming self-determination, to present in one single way—cognition becomes a cognizing by force of grounds [Grunde].

All cognizing is to be such a *cognizing by force of grounds*.

For all cognizing is to come to complete clarity in and for the cognizing personality and consciousness. But if it is to do so, then the productivity required for it, and lying within it, must also come to clear consciousness; and this it can do only in being carried out or undertaken by the individual with self-consciousness and self-determination. Thereby it shows itself as free; but if it is then, as that by which a cognition is to come about, bound to a single determinate presenting, it must be bound to it in accordance with a certain corresponding determining Something which, when it comes to consciousness as such, shows itself as a ground.

Cognition now comes about as the result of an investigation and a deliberation. Reflection and consideration call forth a *study* that steps in between a first immediate receiving and a final or concluding cognition. The mind, which at first opened itself merely to receive and gave itself over purely to contemplation and reception, is now set in motion in such a way that it is itself, by its own self-conscious labor, to bring about the production in which it is to possess truth; and it now seeks, by inquiry and grounding, a principle or first mover for this production of its own. But the cognition that thereby enters is nonetheless, when it now comes about, and as it now turns out, a new receiving and beholding; for in the end we assume what, in accordance with the determining grounds, we see that we must assume. This cognizing by force of grounds is also to be a passage to a complete beholding, in which the full power of truth works immediately and undividedly. But for the free personality, which is to come to complete freedom and self-clarity, it shows itself as a necessary passage.

Remark and Supplement.

1. The ground may, for that matter, well be merely a necessity accompanying pure immediate apprehension and beholding, so that cognition takes place as one that grounds itself; but the question of a ground has now been set in motion, and even if what is assumed is assumed merely because it is immediately certain by itself, this very immediate certainty [Vished] now shows itself as a ground, and cognition now takes on a different character than it had before, when this reflection had not yet entered.

This is especially to be remembered of the mathematical axioms. Sense-intuition, too, no doubt presents itself as immediately grounding itself, and may also remain with this stamp. But even then our representing is not seldom led to find itself as a free reproducing—especially if the sensory shape is so manifold, or the relations of its parts so intricate, that it can come to clarity only by deliberation and consideration; and then what leads to fixing the representation will also come, in opposition to the representation itself, to show itself as its ground. This happens still more when it is noticed that things often cannot, or should not, be represented as being just as the impression would immediately suggest. But once such so-called sense-deceptions have shown themselves as possible, doubt can now arise about the correctness of every immediate, self-forming sense-representation, so that, even if it is directly assumed, this now happens no longer merely on account of its own immediacy, but also on account of a cognition that no so-called sense-deception is present—and the consideration that teaches this now enters as a ground. Indeed, in the advance of the endeavor and of cognition, the whole of sense-intuition finally shows itself (to the philosophical eye) as one whose truth and validity can be doubted at all, and must, moreover, first be warranted and established. And thus the representing that at first formed itself entirely of itself, and seemed reliable enough in itself, will show itself as still needing grounding—in general and in each and every respect.

The intrinsically certain, from which this grounding is to proceed, or by which all other cognition is to be warranted, is now sought on a wholly different side, and cognition rises to a highest Idea, by force of which all else is now to be beheld in its true and full light, in its meaning and truth. But even if this highest Idea is, so far, immediate and resting in itself, we still come to it only by a thinking that must, of course, throughout be guided and determined by grounds—just as the very fact that all else can be clarified by that highest Idea may be the ground on which its cognition rests. And thus we find, at the highest point just as well, a cognizing by force of grounds, as we found the lowest to be in need of grounding; and this because all cognizing comes to actuality only

through a being-determined to a certain representing, a being-determined that, in the advance of the endeavor, must come to consciousness as such. Everywhere the question is asked why we let ourselves be thus determined, by what right this determining power is exercised over us.

2. The perfect cognizing would be one that, independent of all deliberation and grounding with all their unrest and striving movement, would rest wholly in itself alone and be immediately clear and certain in itself, without any question of its grounds arising, or any thought that something other than just what is beheld could be the true. But such certainty and security—a cognition come to rest and fullness in such a beholding—can rest only in the certainty of, indeed in the pure immediate sense or feeling of, the fact that what is thus beheld comes to us directly from the source of truth, is given and told to us by him from whom all truth, like every good and perfect gift, comes. This is the beholding that has been meant by the expression: to behold all things in God. It is the cognizing by which we are to cognize even as we ourselves are cognized—to know what we know because the spirit speaks it thus in us and gives it to us. Then truth no longer stands over against us as the thing we seek; rather, it dwells in us, in that the same that gives all things their essentiality now also gives us cognition—pure, immediate, absolute, or in and for itself, without its passing through any deliberation and reflection and emerging as the result of such. A consciousness and assurance that everything we cognize is given us by God—that our words are not ours, but, as we find them in us, are worked in us by the divine spirit—can alone be that in which this cognition can rest. Christ's cognizing we can conceive only in this way, never as a cognizing by way of reflection and inference.

As a highest goal, as an ideal, such a cognition stands before us. Yet this highest beholding cannot even be regarded as the goal that mere inquiry and grounding, once it reached its completion, could attain. A completed thinking can lead to a completed cognition by way of thinking—to a completed, wholly certain, clear, and self-reposing knowledge according to, and by force of, the highest grounds. But that highest beholding's pure immediacy can be reached only in that the highest true—the eternal source of truth, the spirit—becomes living in us and enlivens us in a wholly different (a differently real) way than the way in which truth, as highest Idea, animates and enlivens a thinking and a grounding.

For the forward-striving human being, however, *the way of thinking* is the one along which he is to advance, in order to press more and more toward the full cognition of truth. It is a more earthly way, on which one attains piece by piece. It belongs to the

sphere in which, within a finitude, under its own striving, a personality is to develop and be raised more and more to clarity and independence—in a life in which it more and more objectifies itself for itself and establishes itself in an existence of its own, yet only in order to ripen to the point where the spirit can now, in its fullness, enter into it as into an individuality now fully developed as its organ. Whereby then, when this point is reached, fullness will enter in place of the piecework; and now thinking—which surely is not to cease—and the fathoming of things—which is not to fall away—will themselves be illuminated by the higher light, enter into the higher peace, and, while an infinite fullness stands before them for contemplation and fathoming, will nonetheless themselves walk the secure course that no longer has constantly to ask itself about the grounds why it assumes what it beholds, why it cognizes what it finds in its grounding, but has in this respect cast out “every witness of human neediness.”

Until it comes to that, all cognition is burdened with *uncertainty*. The immediately given, which is directly beheld, cannot satisfy us, because it is not the true essence on whose cognition everything depends, and because we have of this true essence a fundamental consciousness that drives us to seek something other than what is directly beheld. It itself now points us to something else and higher; but this else and higher we come to only precisely by being thus shown and led to it—that is, in a mediated way—and this mediateness remains, so long as our cognizing is a cognizing by way of thinking, always attached to it for us.

But what can here already lift us above this mediateness is the firm *conviction* [Overbeviisning], forming itself, of its reality. This springs up in the course of our inquiry and grounding, as we are seized by the truth of what is cognized, feel ourselves carried away by it. In the course of our comparing and relating, deliberating and considering, it lifts itself more and more forward and becomes—in the subjective, individual, and personal respect (what concept and insight are in the objective respect)—the moving soul of all thinking and determining, from which it proceeds and to which it finally returns. And thus a *faith* [Tro]—overcoming and dissolving all deficiency in insight and in the developments and fixings of thinking—namely, a *faith in the reality of the fundamental cognition* [Grunderkjendelse]—takes for us the place of that perfect cognition. As faith it is—though awakened and nourished by a grounding, and constantly giving birth to a closer deliberation and grounding of itself—nonetheless not a cognizing by, and by force of, the development of grounds alone, but a more immediate appearance of the power of truth, which, bearing witness to itself, seizes and irresistibly compels to cognition—yet not because there is immediate beholding, but because everything so points and presses

us to this cognition that it shows itself as the center on which everything depends and in which everything rests, and without which we cannot subsist or manage at all. As our life in general, so too our life in cognition must seek its last support and rest in an infinite trust and confidence, and, as the life of a finite being, can in the end rest in nothing else. Yet that here too, as everywhere, divine grace is in the end the one thing on which everything depends and in which everything rests—this we shall come to set before ourselves more closely in what follows. But because we receive only by grace, that too is why we can have only by faith. Everything is in the end given, and must be taken as it is given, in faith toward the Giver. But precisely that which makes cognition not become a total beholding now also opens for this infinite trust the room in which it can show itself as infinite trust—so that the very fact that we do not have the fullness brings it about that attachment, devotion, and love come all the more into view.

And that, then, is what all the life in us aims at, and moreover also all the life that labors to reach a perfect cognition: that we, the more we exert ourselves to have something of our own and to possess something in ourselves, should the more come to feel that we can do nothing and have nothing except what is directly and outright given us; and that, the more we rise in independence and intelligence and command—as regards the manifold and its relative determination—the more we should recognize that, in respect of the One thing that is needful and on which everything depends, we must give ourselves entirely into God’s keeping, who alone works in us both to cognize and to carry out.

3. But it is only of the fundamental cognition (that on which everything depends, and which so far is the One thing needful) that this holds—that it rests, in the end, in a faith and trust. Everything else, which is illuminated by this fundamental cognition and is to be determined in accordance with it, must be beheld as given with it—all in its connection therewith and its consequence therefrom. So that, even if on the one side a faith and trust becomes that in which all conviction rests and cannot but rest, cognition is nonetheless not on that account to cease, on the other side, being a cognition by force of grounds, and of an *insight* arisen through the cognition of grounds. And just as everything cognized in accordance with the fundamental cognition must be cognized so, because we clearly see that the fundamental cognition necessarily entails it, and can follow the whole connection from the single point under consideration up to the highest, so too the fundamental cognition itself must precisely be clearly seen as that which bears the whole connection, and to which this connection necessarily leads. Under which the course will be this: that what was perhaps at first cognized by a certain feeling of

truth—indeed, by a relation to the subjectively human—comes more and more to be evident to thinking in and for itself and in an objective way, until at last a point will be reached where the highest, to which all else points, is evident not merely because it is clearly seen that all else points to it, but because it seems immediately *evident in itself alone*. But this consideration—in which we meet the profound thought underlying the famous so-called ontological proof of God’s existence—leads us over to our next principal proposition. —God bears witness to himself in consciousnesses, and no cognition that God is would be possible if God did not thus bear witness to himself within us, that is, in our gradually forming spiritual life, beholding, and contemplation; indeed, this fundamental consciousness of God (and of one’s own innermost communion with God) is what first makes the human being human. Herein, then, is immediate faith. But should not the same cognition also be able to become just as immediately evident for speculation, so that this evidence too, as evidence, rested only in itself? By which, however—since this evidence too would then have to be given to us, in that it was evident precisely by itself—faith would not cease to be that in which all cognition would in the end rest. Insight and self-evidence, or evidence, are themselves *worked* in us as well; but where there is question of a life working itself forward in consciousness in a real way, and what comes forth is seen as this life’s inner operations, there is grace and governance—and there, moreover, faith, attachment, and trust must show themselves. The purely intelligent is itself something that likewise comes only through real influences from above, and must therefore be received as a gift—and that with trust toward the Giver. In the cognizing that we conceive as Christ’s cognizing, an immediate self-evidence becomes one with the assurance that trust gives; it is faith and beholding in one.

§. 6.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 7.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 8.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 9.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 10.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 11.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 12.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 13.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 14.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 15.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 16.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 17.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 18.

§. 19.

§. 20.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 21.

Remark and Supplement.

§. 22.

Remark and Supplement.

Conclusion.